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Challenges in a world in transition- M2

Prof. Vera Lomazzi

Gender Equality_SDG5

Last time

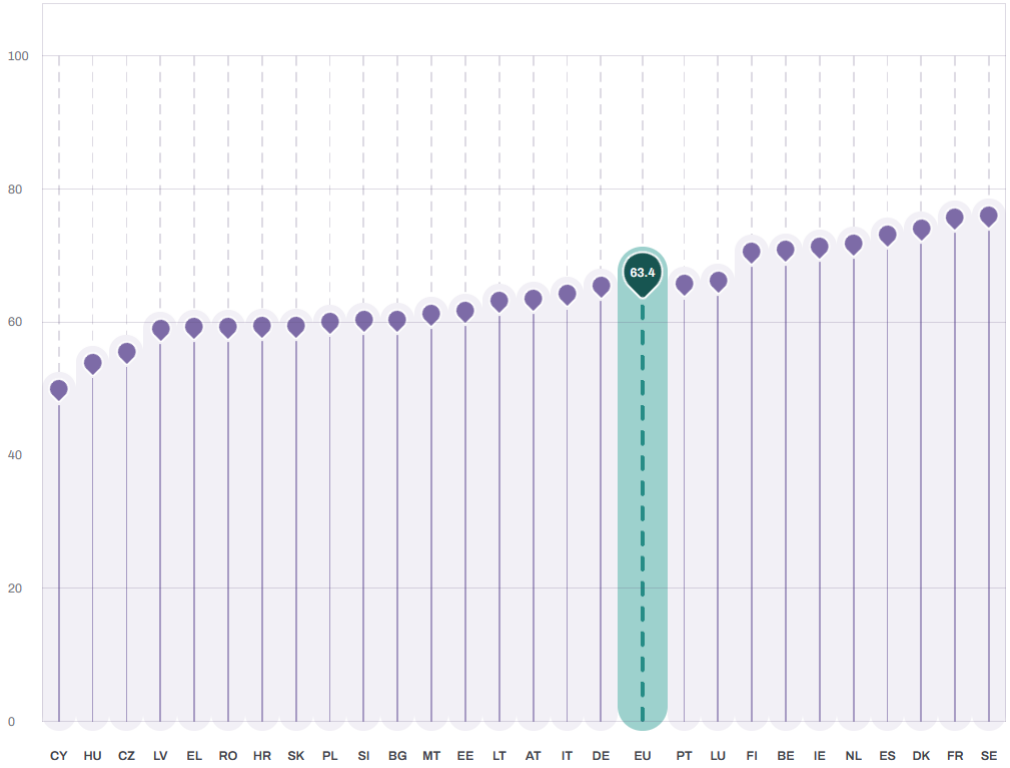
- Gender equality definition
- Measurements of gender equality
  - Source: statistical offices
  - Source: population surveys

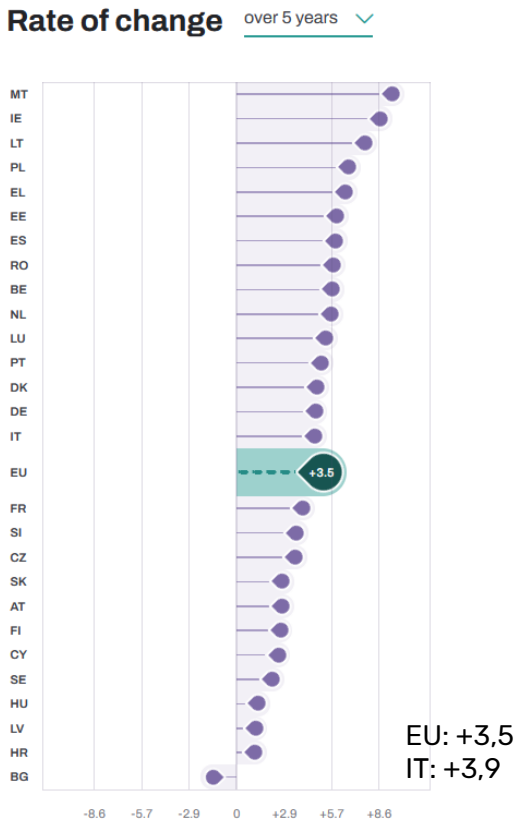
Today

- Information on gender equality from population surveys
- International platforms for gender equality
- SDG5
- Intersectionality
  - Poverty
  - Migration background

European Scenario – Gender Equality Index 2025 (EIGE)

EU: 63,4
Italy: 61,9





EU: +3,5
IT: +3,9

https://eige.europa.eu/gender-equality-index/2025

EIGE Gender Equality Index . Italy 2025

(100=max gender equality)

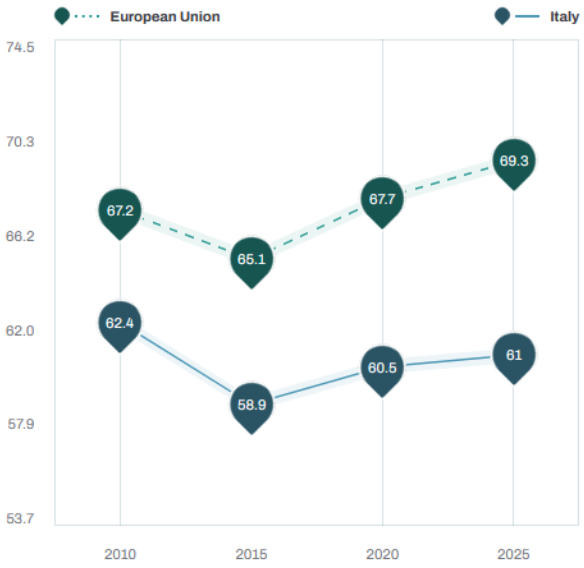


https://eige.europa.eu/gender-equality-index/2025/country/IT

Work versus Time

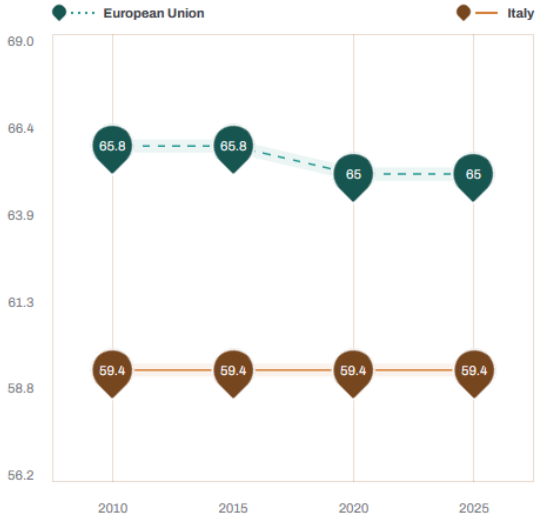
Evolution of change

Select domain Work

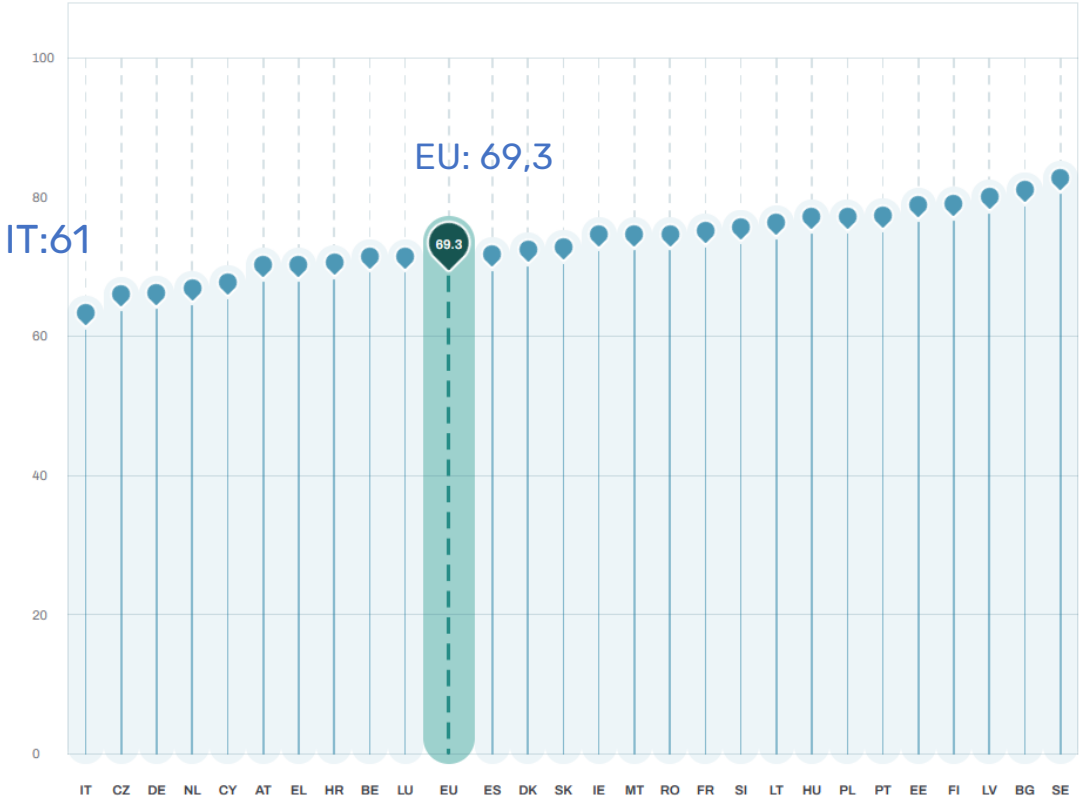


Evolution of change

Select domain Time



Gender Equality Index 2025 (EIGE)
Sub-dimension **WORK**



Indicators included in the calculation of the Work dimension sub-index

Participation
- FTE employment rate (%)
- Length of working life (years)

Segregation
- Employed in education, health and social work (%)
- Ability to take one or two hours off during working hours to attend to personal or family matters (%)
- Index of career prospects (points, 0-100)

https://eige.europa.eu/gender-equality-index/2025/FI/work

Gender inequalities in the labor market

- Gender inequalities in most societies nowadays builds on cultural (invisible) barriers
  - Gender role expectations
  - Social norms (conformity/social control)
  - In some societies different treatments/opportunities/rights are still legitimated by legal laws (example: inheritance share or freedom of movement/driving/traveling)
    - See reservations to CEDAW

Gender inequality in the labor market

- Horizontal segregation
- Vertical segregation
- Gender pay gap

Horizontal segregation



- 2020 (UE), women made
  - 93% education and care professionals
  - 86 % healthcare assistance
  - 95 % cleaners and helpers

Sector	% employed in this sector (IT)	% men on total employed (IT)	% women on total employed (IT)
Education	7,2%	3,1%	12,7%
Manifacturing	18,8%	24%	11,6%
Services	69,7%	59,1%	84,2%

Fonte: Eurostat, 2021, Database: [htec_emp_nat2]

Vertical segregation

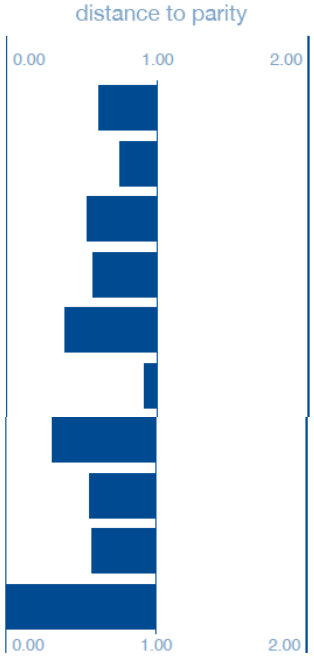


Glass ceiling



Sticky floor

	rank	score	avg	female	male	f/m
Economic participation and opportunity	**114**	**0.609**	**0.583**			
Labour force participation rate, %	98	0.752	0.655	56.5	75.1	0.75
Wage equality for similar work, 1-7 (best)	127	0.533	0.628	–	–	3.73
Estimated earned income, int'l $ 1,000	96	0.572	0.494	29.4	51.4	0.57
Legislators, senior officials and managers, %	98	0.385	0.349	27.8	72.2	0.39
Professional and technical workers, %	87	0.909	0.755	47.6	52.4	0.91
Political empowerment	**41**	**0.313**	**0.218**			
Women in parliament , %	33	0.555	0.312	35.7	64.3	0.56
Women in ministerial positions, %	33	0.572	0.235	36.4	63.6	0.57
Years with female/male head of state (last 50)	76	0.000	0.144	0.0	50.0	0.00



Fonte: Global Gender Gap Report 2021, World Economic Forum: https://www.weforum.org/reports/global-gender-gap-report-2021

Gender Pay Gap

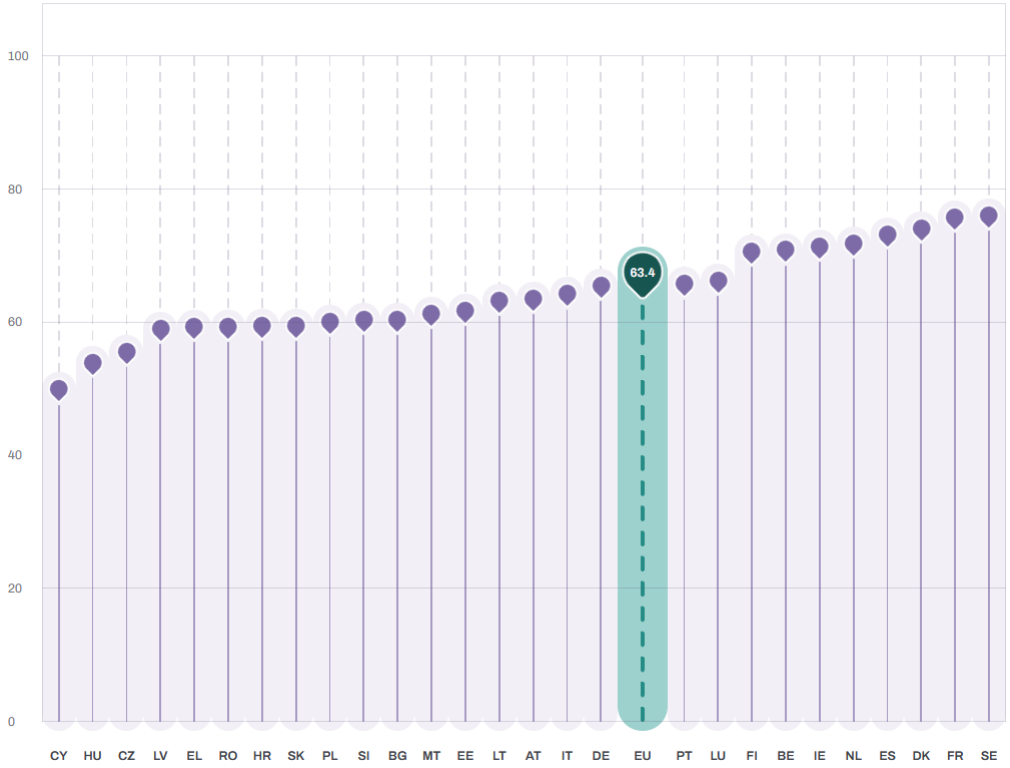


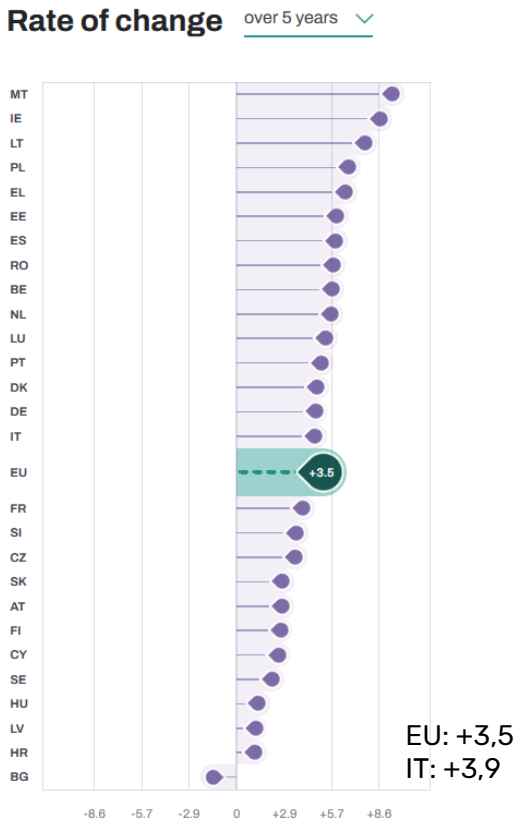
- In Italy: 5% (EU: 15%)
- The GPG measures the difference between average hourly wages expressed as a percentage of the average male wage. When annual wages are considered instead of hourly wages, the differential widens as a result of the lower number of hours worked by the female component (up to *12%)*

Autumn 2021: new law on gender pay gap in Italy

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How gender equality can be measured?

- Gender equality progress is often monitored through indexes built on objective statistics concerning **structural aspects** of equal rights
- But the **cultural orientations** of societies, which are in an interactive relationship with structural contexts, are often neglected.
- These cultural orientations refer to the prevailing complex of values, norms and beliefs in a society and have a relevant role in *shaping individual beliefs and behaviors*, also concerning gender role expectations.
- Examples of population representative surveys:
- Eurobarometer, International Social Survey Programme, Values surveys (European Values Study/World Values survey)

The contribution of values surveys

- Values surveys can provide information at different levels
  - *Individual gender equality values* motivate the pursue for equality in daily life and constitute the most relevant explanatory factor of the unequal distribution of paid and unpaid work between men and women (Davis & Greenstein, 2009).

  - At the aggregate level, information on gender equality values and attitudes can contribute studying *gender cultures* and complement the figures given by macro-indicators (Lomazzi & Crespi, 2019; Pfau-Effinger, 1998).

Instruments in EVS/WVS

- Principle of gender equality
  - gender equality as part of the idea of a democratic society. The respondents are asked to indicate to what extent they consider that “women have the same rights as men” is an essential characteristic of democracy
  - equal rights in the labour market and asks the respondents whether they agree with the statement “When jobs are scarce, men have more right to a job than women”.
  - Equal “share the household chores” among the elements considered important for a successful marriage or partnership
- Gender role attitudes
  - Beliefs concerning the perceived appropriateness of social roles for men and women, in particularly about the division of paid labor, childcare, and housework, on the basis of a gendered separation of tasks and responsibilities (Davis & Greenstein, 2009; Grunow et al., 2018; Lee et al., 2010).
- Moral norms
  - Justification of domestic violence against women

How GRA are measured

- Gender role attitudes (GRA): beliefs on the perceived appropriateness of social roles for men and women

GRA - Domestic domain

- When a mother works for pay, the children suffer

GRA – Public domain

- Men make better political leaders than women do
- University is more important for a boy than for a girl
- Men make better business executives than women do

Gender equality in the labor market

- When jobs are scarce, men have more right to a job than women

1 Agree strongly
2 Agree
3 Disagree
4 Strongly disagree

Reversed score: higher values= higher traditionalism

How justification of VAW is measured in WVS

- Moral norms represent standards that can be used to evaluate and judge personal behaviors and therefore guide conduct. The ideas of fairness and justice underlie the concept of morality (De Waal and de Waal, 1996).

"A man beating his wife can always be justified, never be justified, or something in between" The respondents can express their opinion by using a scale from 1 (never justifiable) to 10 (always justifiable).

Example from a study on gender norms and violence against women https://www.mdpi.com/2076-0760/12/3/117

Country	Istanbul Convention (s = Year of Signature; r = Year of Ratification; e = Year of Entry into Force; w = Withdrawal)	SIGI– Overall Score (%; 100 = Highest Discrimination)	SIGI– Family (%; 100 = Highest Discrimination)	SIGI Physical Integrity (%; 100 = Highest Discrimination)	Justifiability for a Man Beating His Wife. % "Never Justifiable"	Justifiability for a Man Beating His Wife. Gender Gap (%F-%M)	Lifetime Physical and/or Sexual Intimate Partner Violence (%)
Armenia	2018 (s)	28	33	35	90,2	12,1	8,2
Cyprus	2015(s); 2018 (r); 2018 (e)	28	42	12	90,4	1,3	15
Czechia	2016 (s)	20	27	13	62,9	10,5	21
Germany	2011(s); 2017 (r); 2018 (e)	15	18	15	95,7	2,8	22
Greece	2011(s); 2018 (r); 2018 (e)	27	45	9	93,1	5,5	19
Netherlands	2012(s); 2015 (r); 2016 (e)	16	24	13	80,4	6	25
Romania	2014 (s); 2016 (r); 2016 (e)	17	28	8	84,6	6	24
Russia	-	22	23	15	61,3	15	na
Serbia	2012 (s); 2013 (r); 2014 (e)	20	33	7	63,9	8,9	17
Slovakia	2011 (s)	17	26	6	68,9	5,9	23
Turkey	[2011 (s); 2012 (r); 2014 (e)] 2021 (w)	25	33	8	75,0	2,1	38
Ukraine	2011 (s); 2022 (r); 2022 (e)	21	23	14	62,0	11,9	26

International platforms for gender equality

- Gender equality is a **global goal**
- At the current rate, it will take an estimated 300 years to end child marriage, 286 years to close gaps in legal protection and remove discriminatory laws, 140 years for women to be represented equally in positions of power and leadership in the workplace, and 47 years to achieve equal representation in national parliaments.
- Political leadership, investments and comprehensive policy reforms are needed to dismantle systemic barriers to achieving **Goal 5** Gender equality is a **cross-cutting objective** and must be a key focus of national policies, budgets and institutions.

Before SDG5

- Long history of international efforts to fight gender inequality and gender discrimination
- Beside (and before SDGs) relevant platforms to remember:
- CEDAW (UN Convention for the Elimination of Discrimination Against Women)
- Gender mainstreaming
- The Council of Europe Convention on Preventing and Combating Violence Against Women and Domestic Violence (Istanbul Convention)

Transnational framework: CEDAW

- (1979) UN Convention for the Elimination of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW)
- It covers discrimination in several domain of life
  - Family rights (marriage, divorce…)
  - Inheritance rights and land ownership
  - Labor market, education
  - Polital power/representation
  - Freedom of movement
  - ……
- It is the most important international treaty for gender equality legislation worldwide
- Signed by 189 countries (some with reservations)

Country	Year of acceptance	Reservations to articles and main topics (the numbers in parenthesis indicate a specific paragraph of the article)
Kuwait	1994	9(2) (equal rights with men to acquire, change or retain their nationality; equal rights with regard to the nationality of children)16(f) (equal rights in marriage and family life) 29(1) (an article related to the administration of the convention; i.e. arbitration in the event of a dispute)
Libya	1989	2 (policy measures i.e. intention to enshrine gender equality into domestic legislation)16 (equal rights in marriage and family life)
Lebanon	1997	9 (2) (equal rights with men to acquire, change or retain their nationality; equal rights with regard to the nationality of children)16 (1) (c) (d) (f) (g) (equal rights in marriage and family life) 29 (1) (related to the administration of the convention; arbitration in the event of a dispute)
Morocco	1993	2 (policy measures i.e. intention to enshrine gender equality into domestic legislation)15(4) (equal rights to legal capacity and freedom of movement) 29 (an article related to the administration of the convention; i.e. arbitration in the event of a dispute) The reservations were formally withdrawn in 2011.

Extract from «Women's Rights and *Shari'a* Law in the MENA Region» (VLomazzi)

https://brill.com/view/book/edcoll/9789004429604/BP000010.xml

Transnational framework:
Gender Mainstreaming

- GM
  - Global perspective for gender equality (UN world conference 1995)
  - First UN world conference on this topic was in 1975
  - EU: first trasnational strategy since 1997 (Amsterdam Treaty)
- Gender equality recognized in the values of the Union, included in the Chart of Fundamental Rights
- EU developed GM processes with a series of norms, recommendations and through the implementation of four-year action plans
- Impact on national legislation of EU MS; candidate MS
- GM in internal policies and institutions (Council of Europe) and external cooperation

Transnational framework: Istanbul Convention

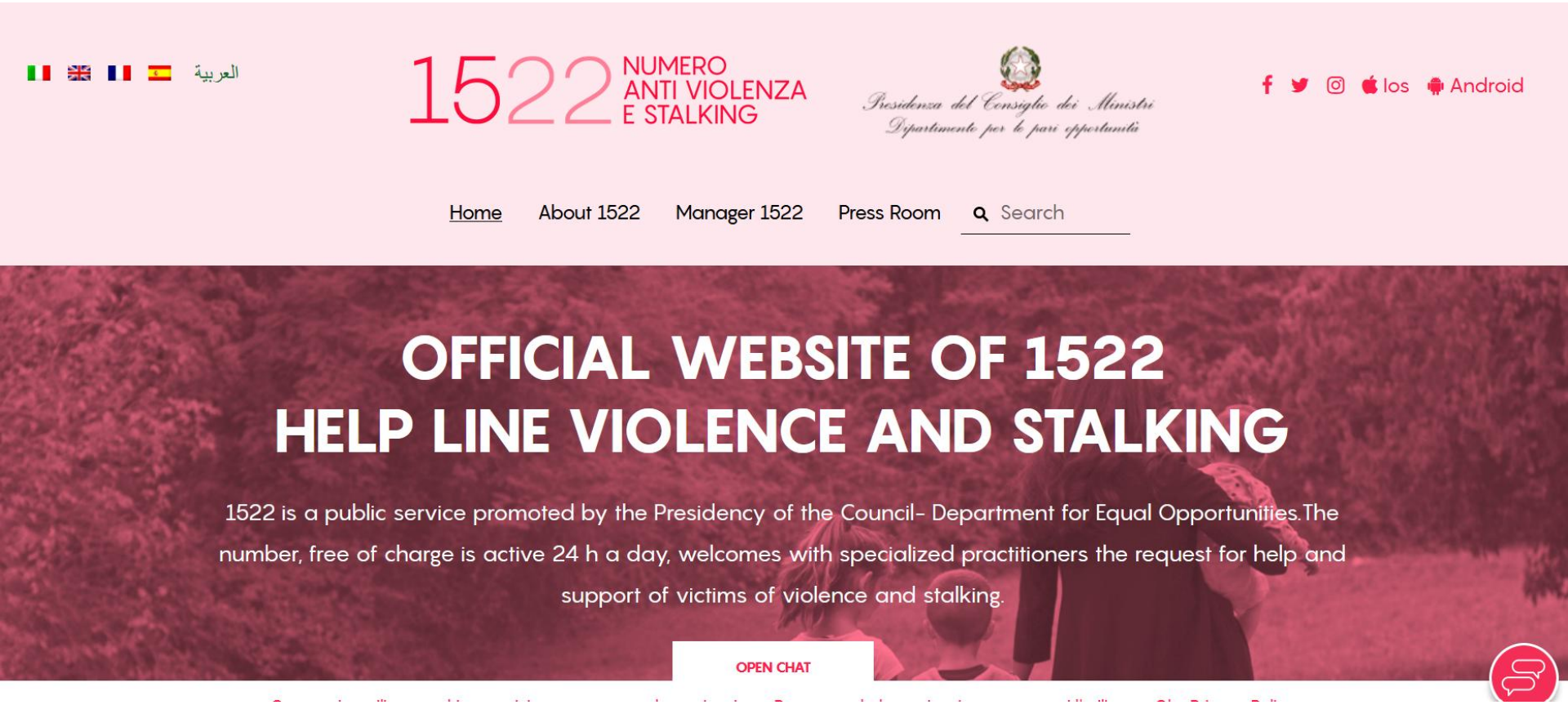
- Human rights Treaty of the Council of Europe on preventing and combating violence against women and domestic violence.
- The Convention defines violence against women as a **violation of human rights** and it is the first comprehensive legally binding instrument aimed at preventing violence, protecting victims, ending the impunity of perpetrators.
- The Convention is open for signature since 2011. As for the CEDAW, countries can sign it, but it is only with ratification and then its entry into force that the adhesion is fully active.

The Istanbul Convention

- The Instanbul convention includes several aspects that countries have to implement
  - Legislation (persecution)
  - Protection of victims of domestic violence
  - Provide shelters and services
  - Provide helpline
  - ..

- For example, if in Italy there is an helpline operating 24/7 is mainly becasue of the implementation of the Convention

1522 Helpline



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How are things going?

A girl born today will have to wait until her 97th birthday – beyond her expected lifespan – to celebrate an equal society



SDG5: Gender equality and women empowerment

How are things going?

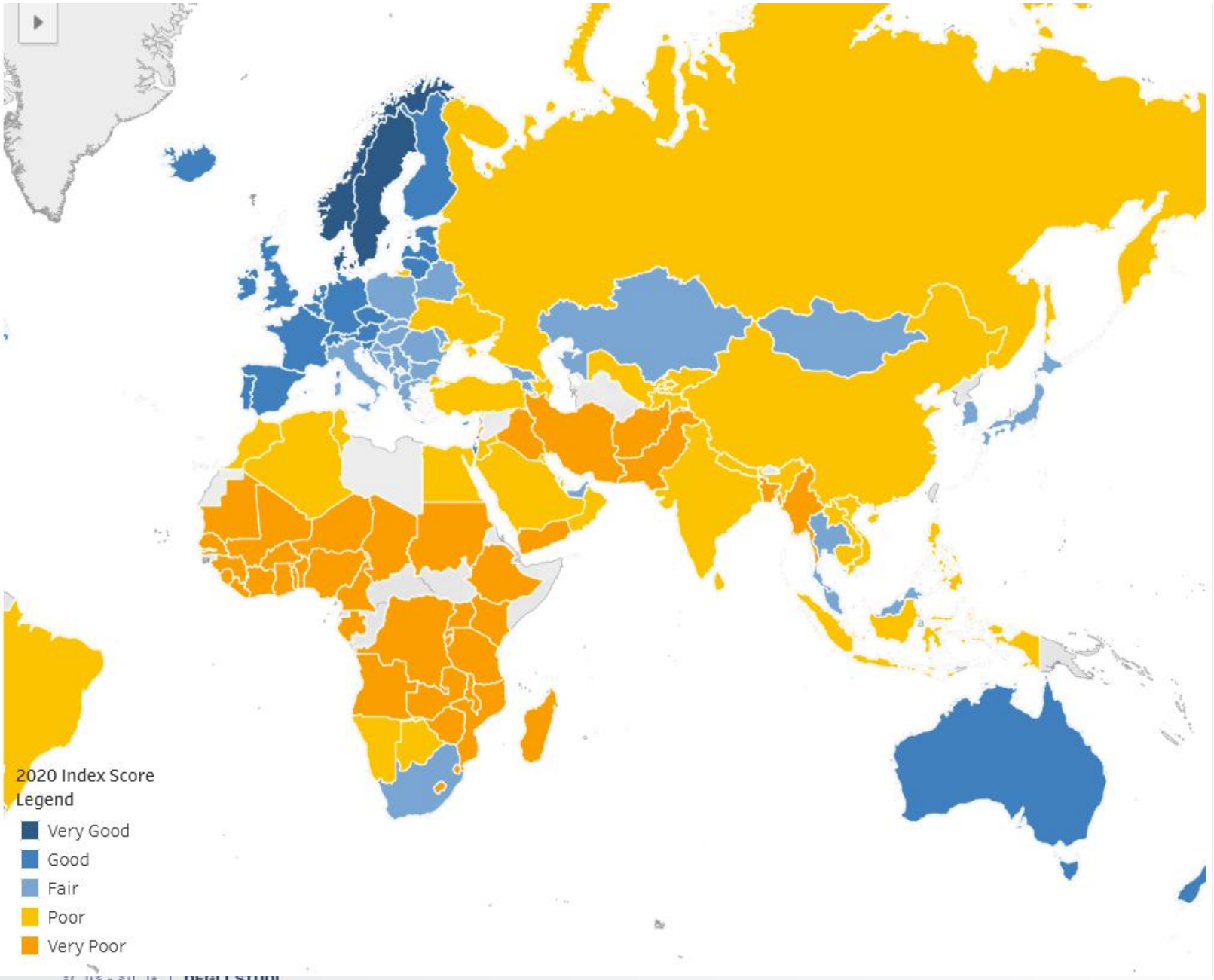
- The 2022 SDG Gender Index finds **little progress** on gender equality at the global level between 2015 and 2020.
- If current trends continue, the global score will reach only 71 out of 100 by 2030, the deadline for the achievement of the SDGs.
- And even this projection could be seen as optimistic, given *the impact the COVID-19 pandemic* has already had on the well-being of girls and women worldwide.

Report 2024



- Less than a quarter of countries are making ‘fast progress’ towards gender equality; a third of countries are either making ‘no progress’ at all or are moving in the ‘wrong direction’.
- On the positive side, more than half of countries worldwide are moving in the right direction on gender equality.
- However, in 2020, more than three billion girls and women still lived in countries with ‘poor’ or ‘very poor’ scores for gender equality

https://equalmeasures2030.org/2024-sdg-gender-index/


2020 Index Score
Legend
Very Good
Good
Fair
Poor
Very Poor

Some highlights

Bigger improvement	No change	Bigger decline
Benin +9,3 (53,7)	Sweden +0,1 (90,3)	Afghanistan -1,9 (38,2)
Saudi Arabia +8,6 (64,4)	Colombia -0,1 (66,8)	Algeria -1,3 (64,3)
Nepal +6,7 (64,2)	Bolivia +0,1 (63,2)	Belarus -1,3 (72,3)
Armenia +6,7 (74,3)	Iceland +0,1 (89)	Kuwait -1,3 (64,9)
Egypt +5,8 (62,4)	Lebanon 0,1 (58,2)	Ecuador -1,1 (68,7)

Full report: https://www.equalmeasures2030.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/03/SDG-index_report_FINAL_EN.pdf

	Very poor	Poor	Fair	Good	Very good	
Fast progress	11 Benin, Burkina Faso, Côte d'Ivoire, Democratic Rep. of Congo, Gambia, Ghana, Iraq, Liberia, Mali, Senegal, Tanzania	8 Cambodia, Egypt, India, Nepal, Russia, Saudi Arabia, Tajikistan, Ukraine	8 Albania, Armenia, Georgia, Malaysia, Moldova, Mongolia, Serbia, United Arab Emirates	1 Israel		28 countries
Some progress	14 Bangladesh, Burundi, Ethiopia, Guinea, Kenya, Lesotho, Madagascar, Mozambique, Niger, Pakistan, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Togo, Zambia	17 Azerbaijan, China, Dominican Rep., El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Indonesia, Jordan, Lao PDR, Morocco, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Philippines, Sri Lanka, Tunisia, Viet Nam	18 Bosnia and Herzegovina, Chile, Costa Rica, Croatia, Hungary, Italy, Malta, Mauritius, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Poland, Slovakia, South Africa, South Korea, Thailand, Trinidad and Tobago, United States, Uruguay	12 Australia, Austria, Canada, Cyprus, Czechia, Estonia, France, Ireland, New Zealand, Portugal, Singapore, Spain	2 Denmark Norway	63 countries
No progress	9 Cameroon, Chad, Iran, Lebanon, Malawi, Mauritania, Nigeria, Uganda, Zimbabwe	11 Bolivia, Botswana, Brazil, Colombia, Jamaica, Kyrgyzstan, Mexico, Namibia, Nicaragua, Turkey, Uzbekistan	6 Argentina, Bulgaria, Greece, Japan, Kazakhstan, Romania	11 Belgium, Finland, Germany, Iceland, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Slovenia, Switzerland, United Kingdom	1 Sweden	38 countries
Decline	2 Afghanistan Venezuela	3 Algeria Ecuador Kuwait	1 Belarus			6 countries

